Hekmatyar and had developed a wide network by mid 1987,' Ashfaq said.

The General and the Holy Warriors

Since the beginning of the bloody war in Afghanistan various mujahideen factions operating from Pakistan had tried in vain to unify the so-called holy warriors into a single organisation. Sometime in 1986, fresh attempts were made by Sibghatullah Mojaddedi, leader of the Jabha-e-Najat-e-Milli Afghanistan, to create an alliance between seven parties with the help of the ISI. Mo-jaddedi and several others refused to acknowledge Dr Najibullah's government and wanted to form an Afghan government in exile before launching an all out attack on Kabul. Although Mojaddedi was named spokesperson of this seven-party alliance that included the Hizb-e-Islami led by Hekmatyar, the Hizb-e-Islami Khalis of Yunus Khalis, the Jamaat-e-Islami headed by Burhanuddin Rabbani, the Harkat-e-Milli-e-Afghanistan led by Nabi Mo-hammadi, the Ittihad-e-Islami Barai Azadi Afghanistan led by Abdul Rasul Sayyaf and the Hizb-e-Inquilab-e-Islami led by Syed Ahmed Gilani, both the ISI and the CIA believed they lacked solidarity. One of the reasons for friction, Reddy argued, was the fundamentalist approach of Hekmatyar, Sayyaf and Rabbani. Mojaddedi was moderate and he worried about funds from Saudi Arabia for fundamentalist units that desired sharia rule in Afghanistan. Mojaddedi also did not like ISI interference in the alliance's politics and in turn the Pakistani agents hated him for being too moderate.

The possibility of a formidable force in the form of a united alliance was renewed with ferocity by General Hamid Gul after he took charge of the ISI. Gul met all the terror outfits' leaders